



CSE212 Theory of Computation and Compilers



Parsers

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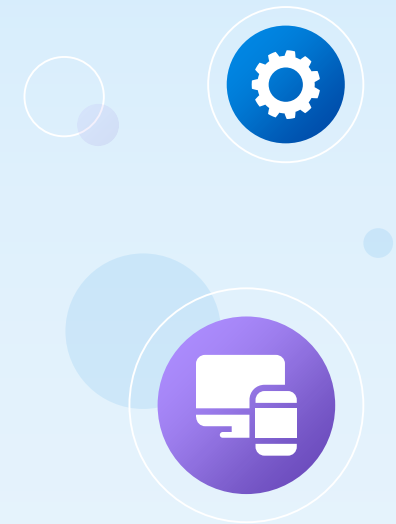


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Parsing



- Parsing: Given a stream **s** of words and a grammar **G**, find a derivation in **G** that produces **s**.
- A CFG, G , is a set of rules, or productions, that describe how to form sentences.
- Sentence: a string of symbols that can be derived from the rules of a grammar
- The Context-free Grammars: For a language **L**, its **CFG** defines the set of strings of symbols that are valid in **L**.
- The collection of sentences that derive from **G** is called the **language** defined by **G**, denoted **L(G)**.
- The set of languages defined by all possible CFGs is called the set of **context-free languages**.

Context-Free Grammars

- **Nonterminal symbol:** a syntactic variable used in a grammar's productions.
- **Terminal symbol:** a word that can occur in a sentence.
- **Derivation:** a sequence of rewriting steps that begins with the grammar's start symbol and ends with a sentence in the language.

1	$Expr$	$\rightarrow$	$(Expr)$
2		$ $	$Expr Op Expr$
3		$ $	name

4	Op	$\rightarrow$	$+$
5		$ $	$-$
6		$ $	$\times$
7		$ $	$\div$

Notes

Context-Free Grammars

Grammar start symbol

Production Rule

1	$Expr$	$\rightarrow$	$(Expr)$
2		$ $	$Expr Op Expr$
3		$ $	name

4	Op	$\rightarrow$	$+$
5		$ $	$-$
6		$ $	$\times$
7		$ $	$\div$

Terminal symbol

Non-Terminal symbol





Parsing

- **Parse tree**: a graph that represents a derivation; also called a syntax tree.
- **Rightmost derivation**: a derivation that rewrites, at each step, the rightmost non-terminal.
- **Leftmost derivation**: a derivation that rewrites, at each step, the leftmost nonterminal.
- **Ambiguity**: A grammar G is ambiguous if some sentence in $L(G)$ has more than one rightmost (or leftmost) derivation.
- **A grammar G** is ambiguous if some sentence in $L(G)$ has more than one parse tree.

Example: Right-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$



1	$Expr \rightarrow (Expr)$	4	$Op \rightarrow +$
2	$Expr Op Expr$	5	$-$
3	name	6	$\times$
		7	$\div$

$(a + b) \times c$

$\underbrace{\hspace{10em}}$

Expr

$(a + b) \times c$

$\underbrace{\hspace{4em}}$ $\underbrace{\hspace{2em}}$

Expr Op Expr

Example: Right-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$



1	$Expr \rightarrow (Expr)$	4	$Op \rightarrow +$
2	$Expr Op Expr$	5	$-$
3	name	6	$\times$
		7	$\div$

Rule	Sentential Form
	Expr
2	Expr Op Expr

Left-most NT

NT

Right-most NT



Example: Right-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$

1	$Expr \rightarrow (Expr)$	4	$Op \rightarrow +$
2	$Expr Op Expr$	5	$-$
3	$name$	6	$\times$
		7	$\div$

Rule	Sentential Form
	$Expr$
2	$Expr Op Expr$
3	$Expr Op name$
6	$Expr \times name$
1	$(Expr) \times name$
2	$(Expr Op Expr) \times name$
3	$(Expr Op name) \times name$
4	$(Expr + name) \times name$
3	$(name + name) \times name$



Example: Right-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$

1	$Expr \rightarrow (Expr)$
2	$ Expr Op Expr$
3	$ name$

4	$Op \rightarrow +$
5	$ -$
6	$ \times$
7	$ \div$

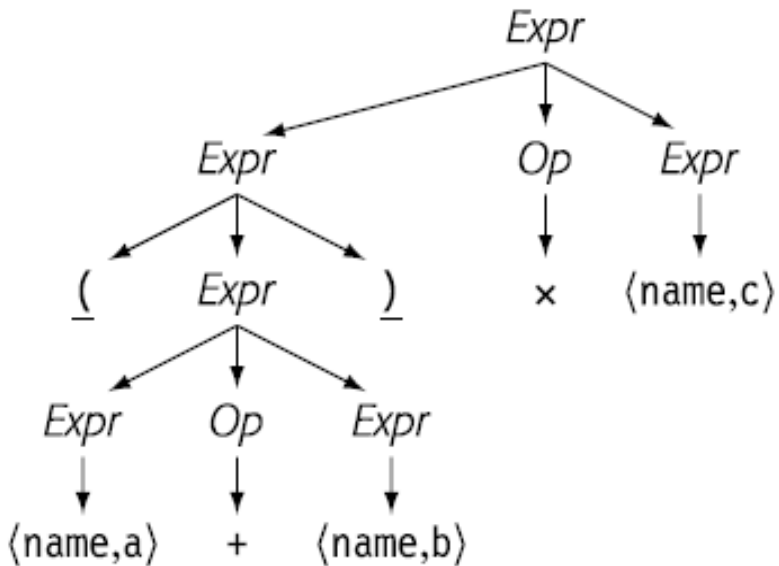
Grammers or CFG

Rule	Sentential Form
	Expr
2	Expr Op Expr
3	Expr Op name
6	Expr $\times$ name
1	(Expr) $\times$ name
2	(Expr Op Expr) $\times$ name
3	(Expr Op name) $\times$ name
4	(Expr + name) $\times$ name
3	(name + name) $\times$ name

Right-most Derivations



Example: Right-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$



(b) Corresponding Rightmost Parse Tree

Right-most Parse Tree (Syntax Tree)

Rule	Sentential Form
	Expr
2	Expr Op Expr
3	Expr Op name
6	Expr × name
1	(Expr) × name
2	(Expr Op Expr) × name
3	(Expr Op name) × name
4	(Expr + name) × name
3	(name + name) × name

Right-most Derivations



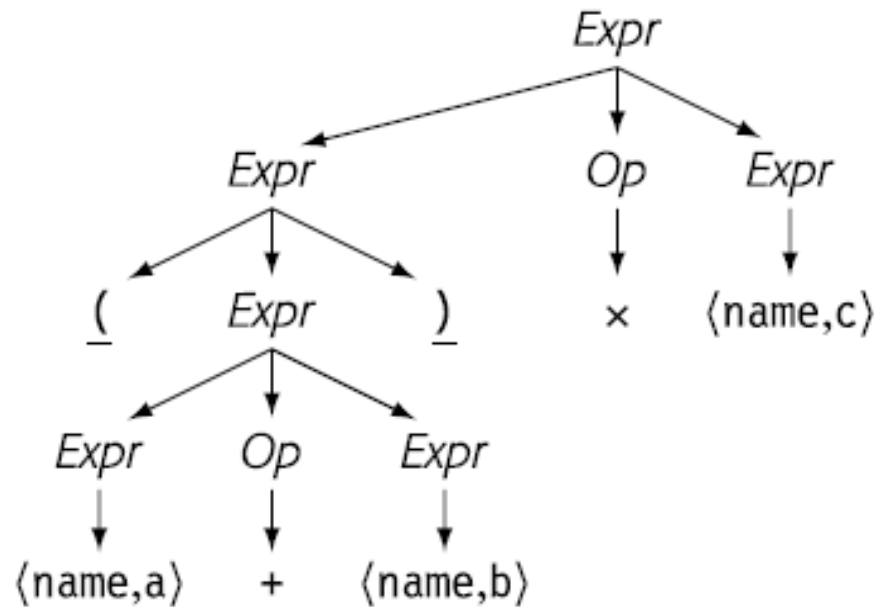
Example: Left-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$

1	$Expr \rightarrow (Expr)$	4	$Op \rightarrow +$
2	$Expr Op Expr$	5	$-$
3	name	6	$\times$
		7	$\div$

Rule	Sentential Form
	Expr
2	Expr Op Expr
1	(Expr) Op Expr
2	(Expr Op Expr) Op Expr
3	(name Op Expr) Op Expr
4	(name + Expr) Op Expr
3	(name + name) Op Expr
6	(name + name) $\times$ Expr
3	(name + name) $\times$ name



Example: Left-most derivation of $(a + b) \times c$



(d) Corresponding Leftmost Parse Tree

Rule	Sentential Form
	Expr
2	Expr Op Expr
1	(Expr) Op Expr
2	(Expr Op Expr) Op Expr
3	(name Op Expr) Op Expr
4	(name + Expr) Op Expr
3	(name + name) Op Expr
6	(name + name) x Expr
3	(name + name) x name

Parsing

- ▣ Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$



Parsing



- ▣ Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Solution:

- Is this grammar is ambiguous? If yes: it is not suitable
- To prove the grammar ambiguity, Choose a sentence and Do a parse tree derivation

Parsing



- ▣ Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: $()()()$

Parsing



- ▣ Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: `()()`

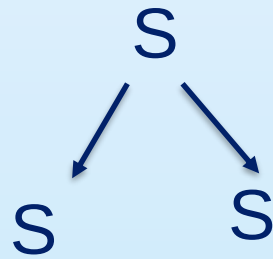
`S`

Parsing

- Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: `()()`

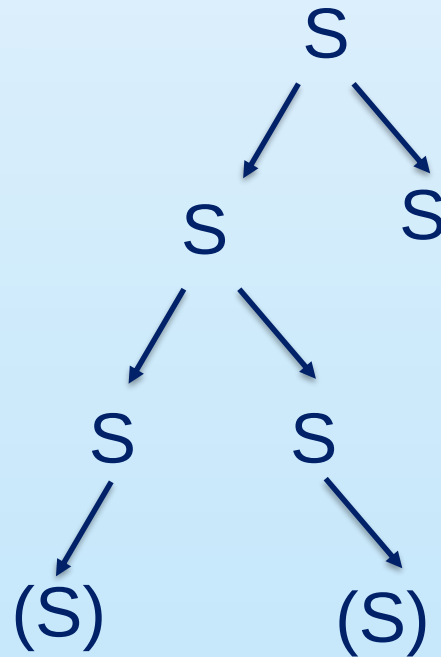


Parsing

- Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: $()()()$

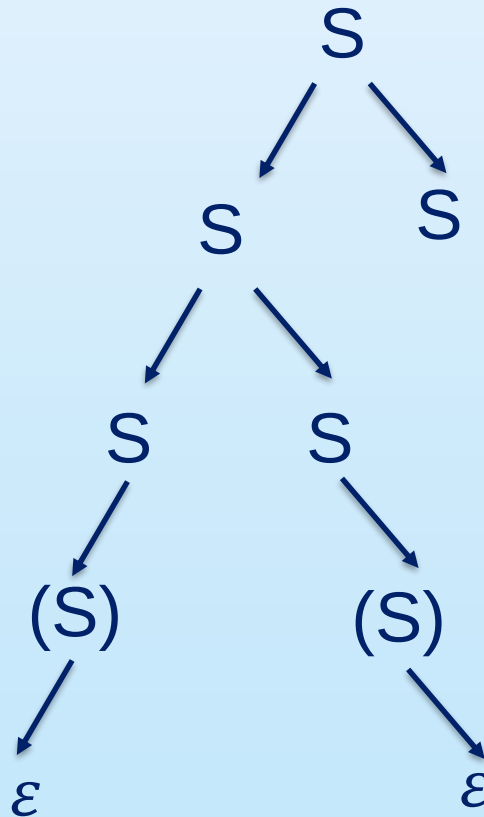


Parsing

- Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: $()()()$

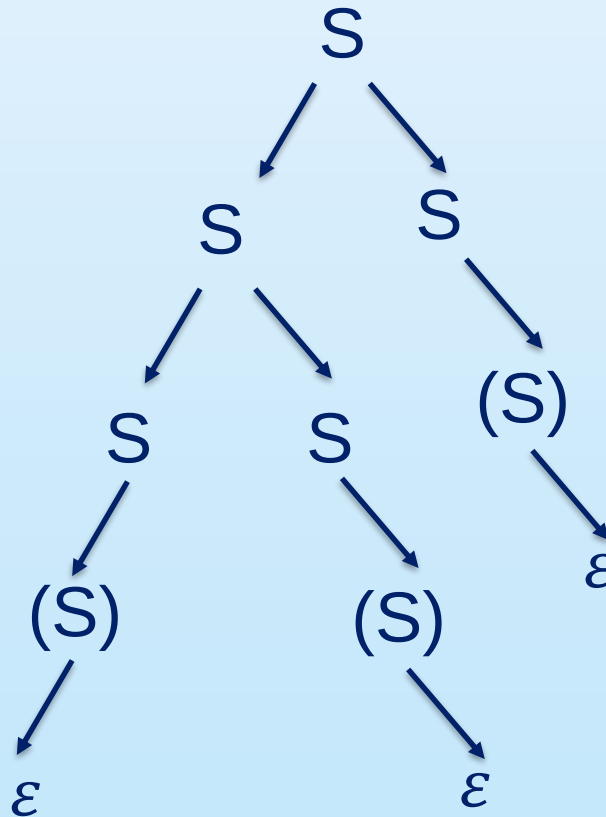


Parsing

- Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: $()()()$

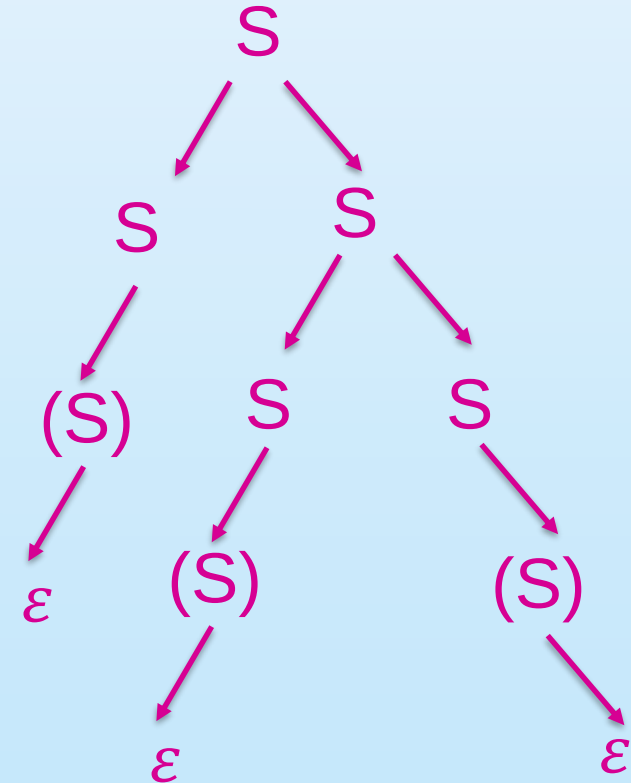
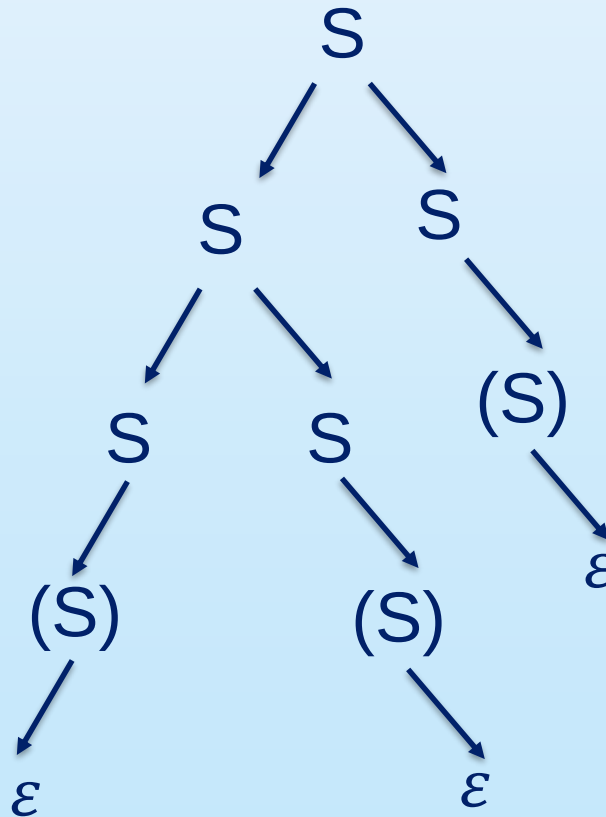


Parsing

- Determine whether the following grammar is suitable for predictive parsing,

$$S \rightarrow (S) | SS | \varepsilon$$

Sentence: $()()()$



Parsing

- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - G1: $S \rightarrow SbS|a$
 - G2: $S \rightarrow aB|ab, A \rightarrow AB|a, B \rightarrow ABb|b$
- Q1: for G2, Define N, T, P, S
- Q2: Which of the following option is correct:
 - Only G1 is ambiguous
 - Only G2 is ambiguous
 - Both G1 and G2 are ambiguous
 - Both G1 and G2 are unambiguous

Parsing

- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - $G1: S \rightarrow SbS|a$
 - $G2: S \rightarrow aB|ab, A \rightarrow AB|a, B \rightarrow ABb|b$
- Q1: for G2, Define N, T, P, S
 - **Non-terminals N:** S, A, B
 - **Terminals T:** a, b
 - **Start Symbols S:** S
 - **Production Rules P:** $S \rightarrow aB|ab, A \rightarrow AB|a, B \rightarrow ABb|b$

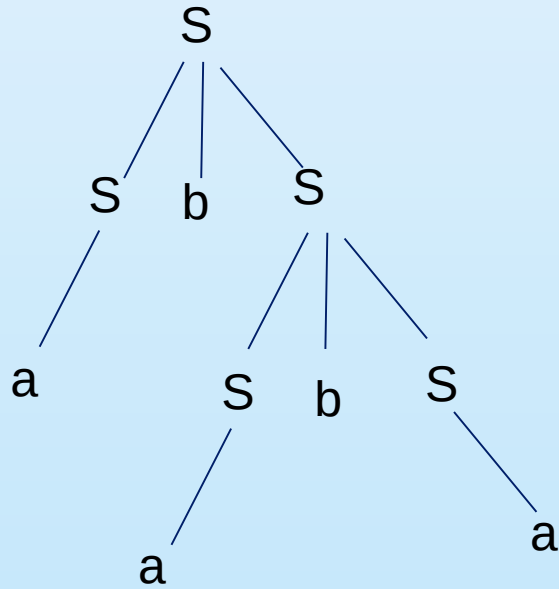
Parsing

- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - G1: $S \rightarrow SbS|a$
 - G2: $S \rightarrow aB|ab$, $A \rightarrow AB|a$, $B \rightarrow ABb|b$
- Q2: Which of the following option is correct:
 - Only G1 is ambiguous
 - Only G2 is ambiguous
 - Both G1 and G2 are ambiguous
 - Both G1 and G2 are unambiguous

Parsing

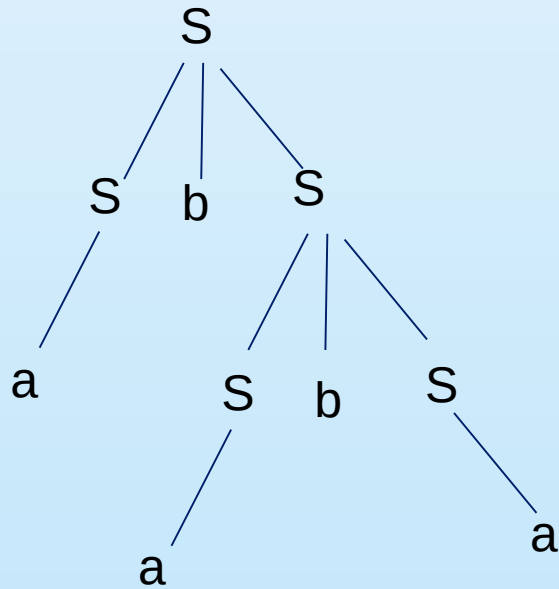
- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - $G1: S \rightarrow SbS|a$

Consider a sentence: ababa

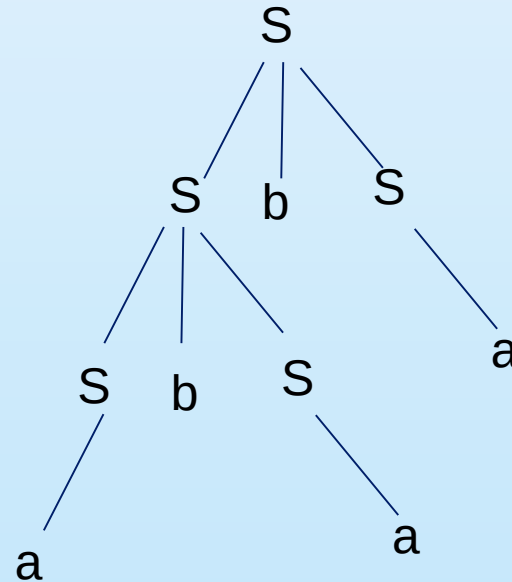


Parsing

- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - $G1: S \rightarrow SbS|a$



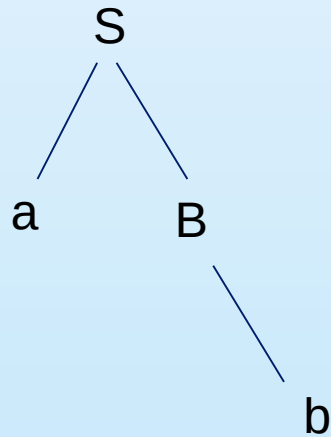
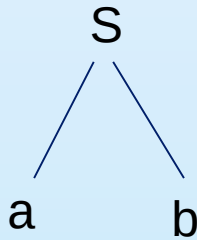
Consider a sentence: ababa



Parsing

- Consider the following two Grammars,
 - $G2: S \rightarrow aB|ab, A \rightarrow AB|a, B \rightarrow ABb|b$

Consider a sentence: ab



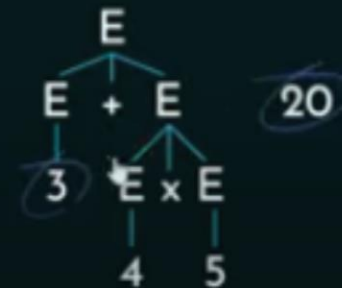
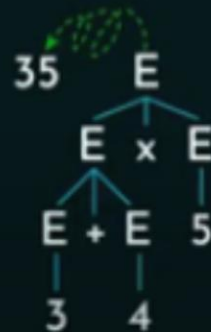
Ambiguity

- Ambiguity Problems:
 - Precedence Property Violation
 - Associativity Property Violation

1. $E \rightarrow E + E$
2. $E \rightarrow E \times E$
3. $E \rightarrow \text{id}$

3 + 4 x 5

Ambiguous Grammar Causes Precedence Violation.



Ambiguity

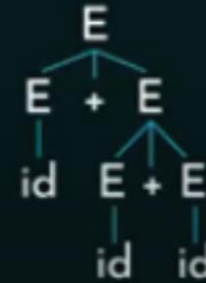
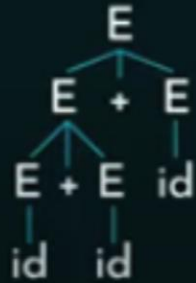
- Ambiguity Problems:
 - Precedence Property Violation
 - Associativity Property Violation

1. $E \rightarrow E + E$
2. $E \rightarrow E \times E$
3. $E \rightarrow id$

$id + id + id$

$(id + id) + id$

Ambiguous Grammar Causes Associativity Violation.



Ambiguity

- Ambiguity Problems:
 - Precedence Property Violation
 - Associatively Property Violation

1. $E \rightarrow E + E$
2. $E \rightarrow id$

$id + id + id$

Ambiguous Grammar Causes Associativity Violation.



$(id + id) + id$



$id + (id + id)$

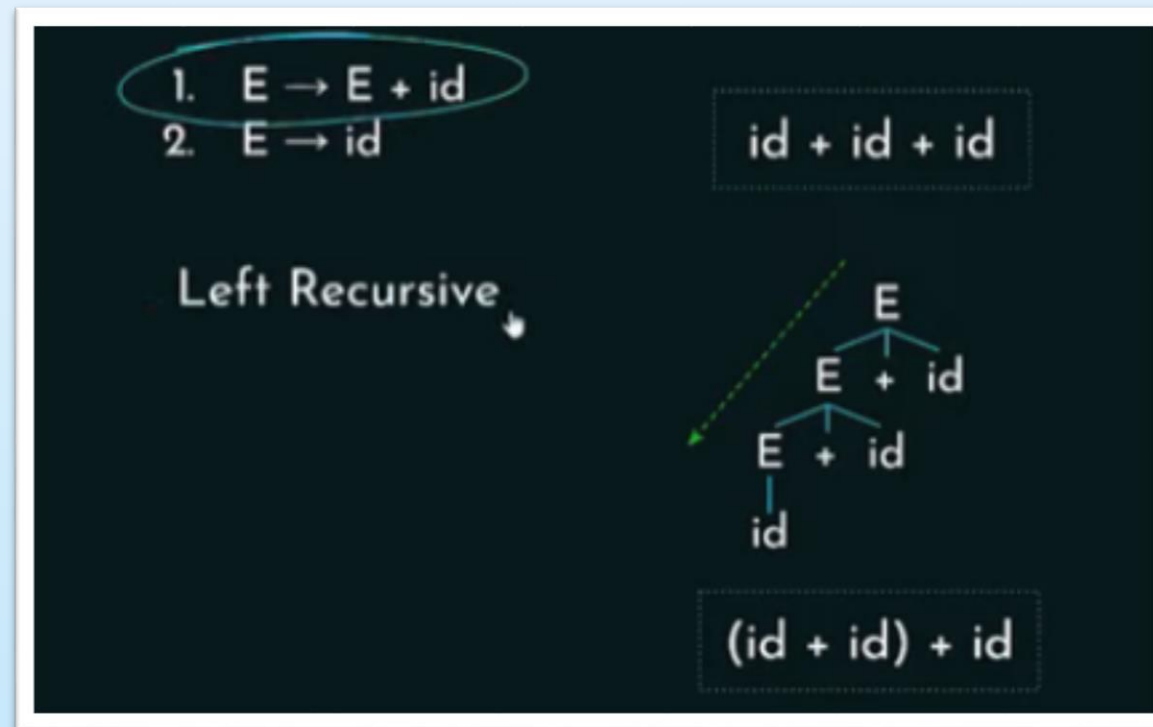
Ambiguity

- **Ambiguity Problems:**
 - Precedence Property Violation
 - Associativity Property Violation (**Solution**)
 - Left Recursion = NT on the left of P = Left association
 - Right Recursion = NT on the right of P = Right association



Ambiguity

- Ambiguity Problems:
 - Precedence Property Violation
 - Associativity Property Violation

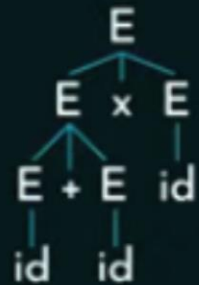


Ambiguity

- **Ambiguity Problems:**
 - Precedence Property Violation (**Solution**)
 - Associativity Property Violation

$E \rightarrow E + E \mid E \times E \mid id$

$id + id \times id$

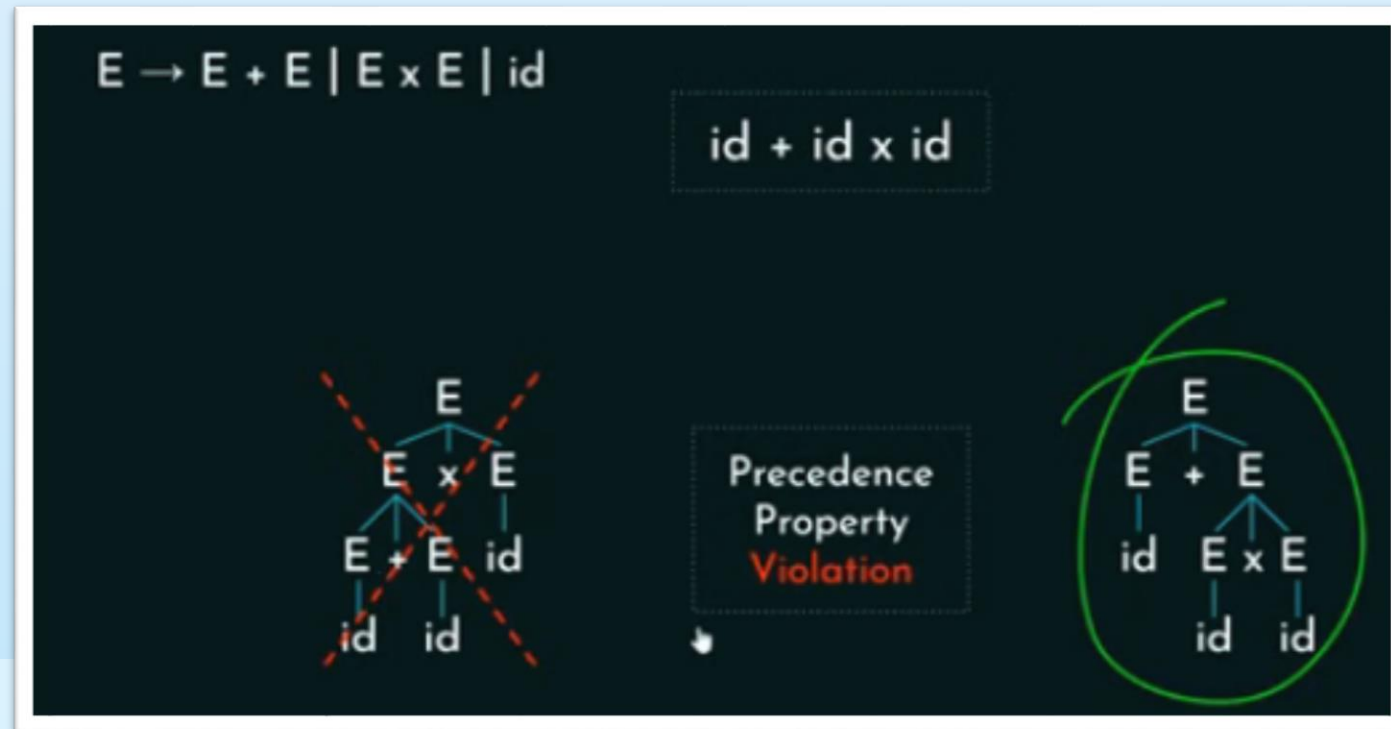


□ Ambiguity Problems:

□ Precedence Property Violation

□ Tree is traversed from bottom to top and from left to right. The correct results are produced when the operator of higher precedence is in the lower level.

□ Associativity Property Violation



Ambiguity

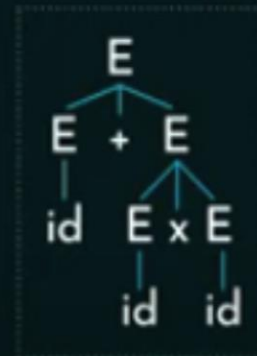
$E \rightarrow E + E \mid E \times E \mid id$



1. $E \rightarrow E + T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F$

Precedence Property

$E \rightarrow E + E \mid E \times E \mid id$



1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F$

Ambiguity

1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
3. $F \rightarrow id$

Precedence Property resolved by
defining levels

$id + id \times id$



Example

1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
3. $F \rightarrow G \wedge F \mid G$
4. $G \rightarrow \text{id}$

Determine Associativity and Precedence of the operators:

A diagram illustrating left associativity. It shows a sequence of operators: +, x, and ^. A dashed line with arrows connects them from left to right, indicating that operations are performed in that order. Below the diagram, the text 'Left Associative' is written.

Left Associative

1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$

Example

1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
3. $F \rightarrow G \wedge F \mid G$
4. $G \rightarrow \text{id}$

Determine Associativity and Precedence of the operators:



1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
3. $F \rightarrow G \wedge F \mid G$

Example

1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
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Determine Associativity and Precedence of the operators:



1. $E \rightarrow E + T \mid T$
2. $T \rightarrow T \times F \mid F$
3. $F \rightarrow G \wedge F \mid G$
4. $G \rightarrow \text{id}$

► Precedence:



Example

Consider the following ambiguous CFG on boolean expressions:

$\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp AND bExp} \mid \text{bExp OR bExp} \mid \text{NOT bExp} \mid \text{True} \mid \text{False}$

The precedence of the boolean operators are NOT, AND, OR (high to low).
AND, OR have left to right associativity.

1. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp OR bExp}$
2. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp AND bExp}$
3. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{NOT bExp}$
4. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{True}$
5. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{False}$

Example

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The precedence of the boolean operators are NOT, AND, OR (high to low).
AND, OR have left to right associativity.

1. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp OR bExp1}$
2. $\text{bExp1} \rightarrow \text{bExp1 AND bExp2}$
3. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{NOT bExp2}$
4. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{True}$
5. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{False}$

Example

Consider the following ambiguous CFG on boolean expressions:

$\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp AND bExp} \mid \text{bExp OR bExp} \mid \text{NOT bExp} \mid \text{True} \mid \text{False}$

The precedence of the boolean operators are NOT, AND, OR (high to low).
AND, OR have left to right associativity.

1. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp OR bExp1} \mid \text{bExp1}$
2. $\text{bExp1} \rightarrow \text{bExp1 AND bExp2} \mid \text{bExp2}$
3. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{NOT bExp2}$
4. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{True}$
5. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{False}$

Example

Consider the following ambiguous CFG on boolean expressions:

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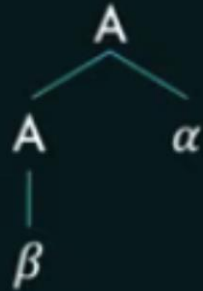
1. $\text{bExp} \rightarrow \text{bExp OR bExp1} \mid \text{bExp1}$
2. $\text{bExp1} \rightarrow \text{bExp1 AND bExp2} \mid \text{bExp2}$
3. $\text{bExp2} \rightarrow \text{NOT bExp2} \mid \text{True} \mid \text{False}$

Left and Right Recursions

Left Recursion

$$A \rightarrow A\alpha \mid \beta$$

A
|
 β



$$S \rightarrow T \times P$$

$$T \rightarrow U \mid T \times U$$

$$P \rightarrow Q + P \mid Q$$

$$Q \rightarrow \text{id}$$

$$U \rightarrow \text{id}$$

$$T \rightarrow T \times U$$

$$P \rightarrow Q + P$$

Left recursive

Right recursive

Left and Right Recursions

Left Recursion

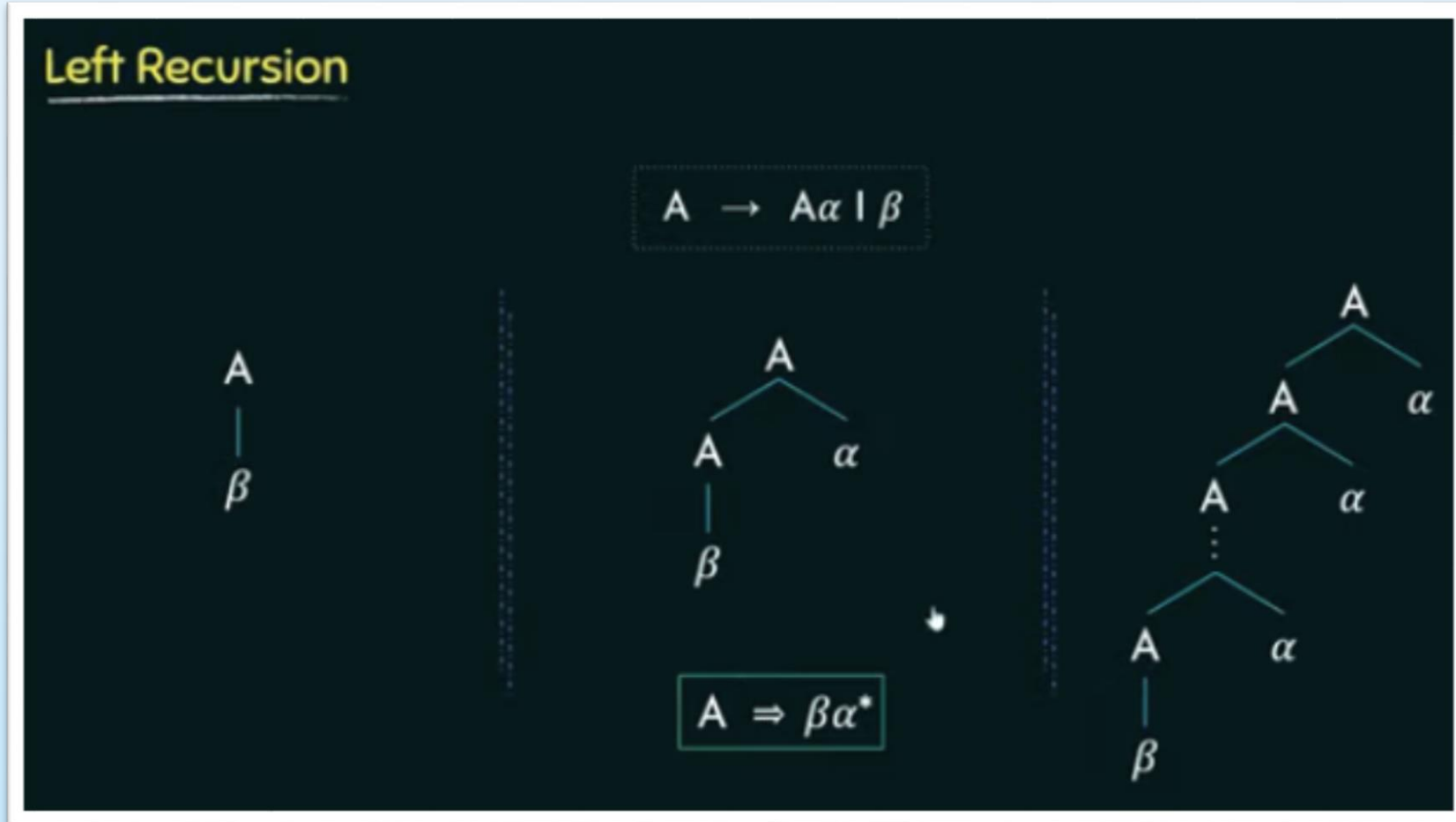
$$A \rightarrow A\alpha \mid \beta$$

A
|
 β

A
/ \
A α
|
 β

A
/ \
A α
/ \
A α
|
 $\vdots$
/ \
A α

Left and Right Recursions



Left and Right Recursions

Right Recursion

$$A \rightarrow \alpha A \mid \beta$$

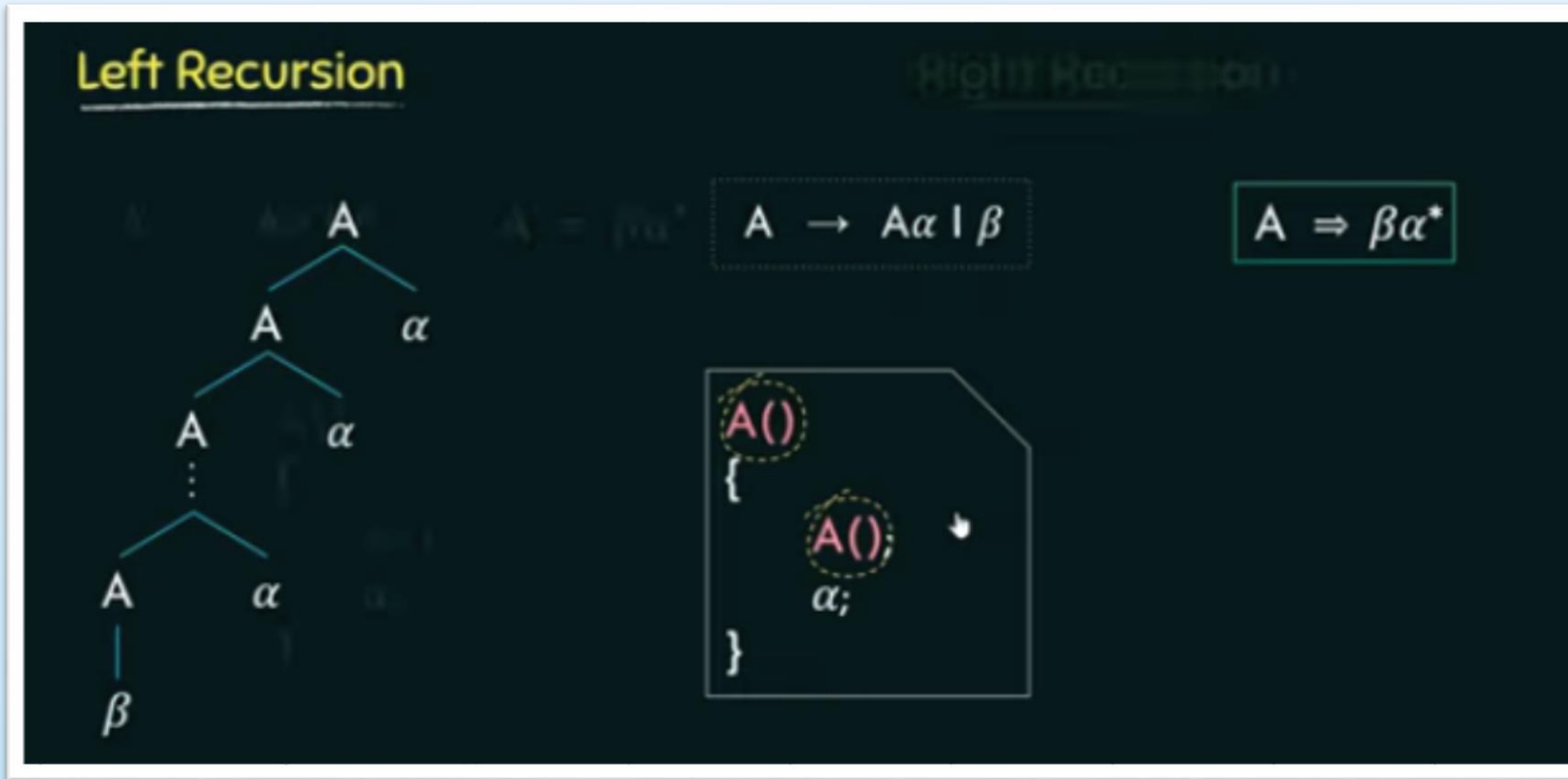
A
|
 β



$$A \Rightarrow \alpha^* \beta$$



Left and Right Recursions



Problem with Left recursion is the infinite loop and confuses the top-down parser

Left and Right Recursions

Left Recursion

$$A \rightarrow A\alpha \mid \beta$$

$$A \Rightarrow \beta\alpha^*$$

```
A()  
{  
    A();  
    α;  
}
```

Right Recursion

$$A \rightarrow \alpha A \mid \beta$$

$$A \Rightarrow \alpha^*\beta$$

```
A()  
{  
    α;  
    A();  
}
```

Left Recursion (solution: Right Recursion)

Conversion

$$A \rightarrow A\alpha \mid \beta$$

$$A \Rightarrow \beta\alpha^*$$

$$A \rightarrow \beta A'$$

$$A' \rightarrow \alpha A' \mid \varepsilon$$

Right recursive

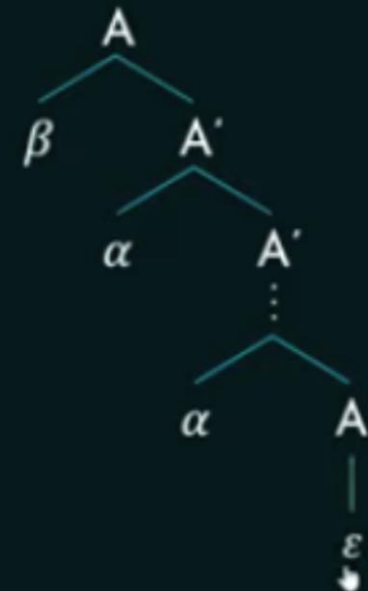
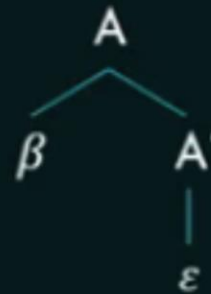
Left Recursion (solution: Right Recursion)

Conversion

$$A \rightarrow A\alpha \mid \beta$$

$$A \Rightarrow \beta\alpha^*$$

$$\begin{aligned} A &\rightarrow \beta A' \\ A' &\rightarrow \alpha A' \mid \varepsilon \end{aligned}$$



Left Recursion (solution: Right Recursion)

Eliminate Left Recursion

Ex1: $P \rightarrow P + Q \mid Q$

$A \rightarrow A \alpha \mid \beta$

$$P \rightarrow QP'$$
$$P' \rightarrow +QP' \mid \epsilon$$

$$A \rightarrow \beta A'$$
$$A' \rightarrow \alpha A' \mid \epsilon$$

Parse Tree Construction Approaches



- Two distinct and opposite approaches for constructing the tree:
 - **Top-Down Parsers** begin with the root and grow the tree toward the leaves. At each step, a top-down parser selects a node for some nonterminal on the lower fringe of the partially built tree and extends it with a subtree that represents the right-hand side of a production that rewrites the nonterminal.
 - **Bottom-Up Parsers** begin with the leaves and grow the tree toward the root. At each step, a bottom-up parser finds a substring of the partially built parse tree's upper fringe that matches the right-hand side of some production; it then builds a node for the rule's left-hand side and connects it into the tree.

Thanks!

